PWMS Users API — User Guide

Read-only parliamentary user register · API v1 · for approved partner applications

Before you start

Your PWMS administrator gives you:

- the base address, e.g. `https://pwms.example.gov.za`
- a **client ID** and **client secret**
- the **`users:read`** scope

Keep the secret private. If it is exposed, ask for it to be rotated. The API is read-only: you cannot create, edit or deactivate users. Interactive documentation: `/api/v1/docs`.

1. Get an access token

```
POST /api/v1/auth/token/
curl -s -X POST "$BASE/api/v1/auth/token/" \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{"client_id":"YOUR_ID","client_secret":"YOUR_SECRET"}'
```

The response contains `access_token`, `refresh_token`, `expires_in` (900 seconds) and `refresh_expires_in` (86400 seconds).

- **Access token:** 15 minutes. Send it as `Authorization: Bearer <token>` on every call.
- **Refresh token:** 24 hours, single use. Exchange it at `POST /api/v1/auth/token/refresh/` with `{"refresh_token":"…"}` to get a new pair.
- On `401`, refresh (or obtain a new pair), then retry once.

2. Endpoints

Method and path	What it returns
`GET /api/v1/users/`	List, search and filter users
`GET /api/v1/users/{public_id}/`	One user by their UUID
`GET /api/v1/search/`	Combined search; use `resources=users`
`GET /api/v1/me/`	Your client ID and scopes (not a person)

Every request needs `Authorization: Bearer <access_token>`.

3. Filters

Parameter	Use
`search`	Case-insensitive substring across all searchable fields
`search_fields`	Comma-separated subset of the searchable fields (below)
`is_active`	`true` / `false`
`is_mp`	`true` / `false` — Members of Parliament
`is_staff_member`	`true` / `false` — staff members
`department`	Group UUID, name, short name or slug
`ordering`	`last_name` (default), `first_name`, `username`, `date_joined`; prefix with `-` to reverse
`limit` / `offset`	Page size (default 20, max 100) / records to skip

Searchable fields: `username`, `first_name`, `middle_name`, `last_name`, `email`, `positiondesc`, `department`, `constituency`, `party_affiliation`, `phone`.

4. Example requests

```
# Active Members of Parliament, by surname
curl -sG "$BASE/api/v1/users/" \
  -H "Authorization: Bearer $TOKEN" \
  --data-urlencode "is_active=true" \
  --data-urlencode "is_mp=true" \
  --data-urlencode "ordering=last_name"

# Search by first and last name
curl -sG "$BASE/api/v1/users/" \
  -H "Authorization: Bearer $TOKEN" \
  --data-urlencode "search=Alice Molefe" \
  --data-urlencode "search_fields=first_name,last_name"

# Users in a department
curl -sG "$BASE/api/v1/users/" \
  -H "Authorization: Bearer $TOKEN" \
  --data-urlencode "department=Portfolio Committee on Health"

# One user
curl -s "$BASE/api/v1/users/PUBLIC_ID/" \
  -H "Authorization: Bearer $TOKEN"
```

Use `curl -G --data-urlencode` (or your library's query parameters) for names with spaces or punctuation.

5. Pages and fields

A list response is a page with `count`, `limit`, `offset`, `next`, `previous` and `results`. Follow `next` until it is `null`; the links keep your search and filters.

Each user includes `public_id`, `username`, `title`, `first_name`, `middle_name`, `last_name`, `display_name`, `email`, `employee_type`, `positiondesc`, `department`, `supervisor`, `is_active`, `is_mp`, `is_staff_member`, `constituency`, `party_affiliation` and `phone`.

`department` is a nested object with `public_id`, `name`, `short_name` and `group_type`. `supervisor` is a nested object with `public_id`, `username` and `display_name`; it is `null` when no manager is recorded, and the supervisor's own manager is not expanded.

Identity numbers, date of birth, gender, bio/avatar and the list of direct reports are deliberately not exposed.

6. Common responses

Status	Meaning and action
`200`	Success
`400`	Invalid parameter; correct the request
`401`	Missing/expired token; refresh or get a new pair
`403`	Key lacks `users:read`; contact the administrator
`404`	No user with that `public_id`
`429`	Rate limit; wait for `Retry-After`, then retry

7. Practical tips

- Refresh before the 15-minute access token expires; handle `401` once.
- Send booleans as `true` / `false`, e.g. `is_mp=true`.
- Use the `public_id`, not an internal ID or a username, as the stable identifier.
- Request only the page size you need; 20–50 keeps responses fast.
- Each key has a requests-per-minute limit (60 by default; your registration may differ).
- The token endpoint is limited to 20 requests per minute per IP address.
- Contact the PWMS administrator if a person is missing or you need another scope.